

Revenue Decoded: Insights from 1,000 Startups

What's In The Dataset

A snapshot of 1,000 startups tracked on TrustMRR, each with revenue, growth, audience and marketplace fields

1,000

Companies tracked

29

Data fields per company

65

Countries represented

29

Business categories

Core metrics defined

- **MRR (Monthly Recurring Revenue)** Predictable revenue billed every month from active subscriptions
- **Revenue windows** 30-day, 3-month, 12-month, and all-time revenue reported separately
- **Growth %** Month-over-month change in revenue and MRR
- **Marketplace fields** on_sale flag, asking price, and revenue multiple for businesses listed for sale

Data quality note

274 of 1,000 companies (27%) have no category assigned — including the single largest company in the dataset. Category-level analysis therefore covers ~73% of total revenue.

Only 142 companies report visitor traffic, so revenue-per-visitor should be read as a thin sample.

Revenue Follows A Steep Power Law

A tiny number of companies account for almost all revenue in the dataset

\$334M

Total all-time revenue

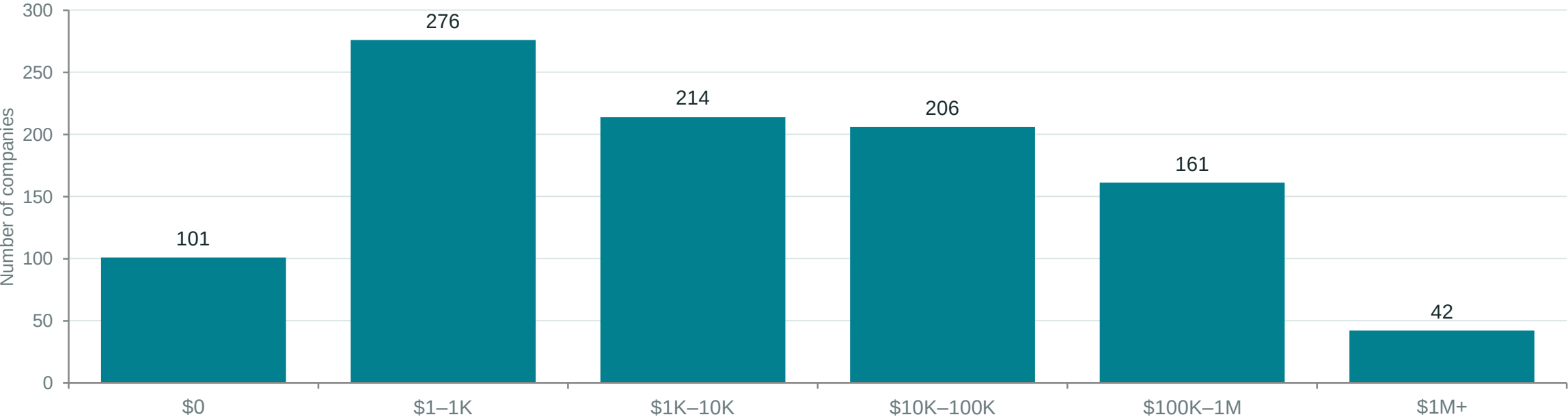
\$3,620

Median company revenue

61%

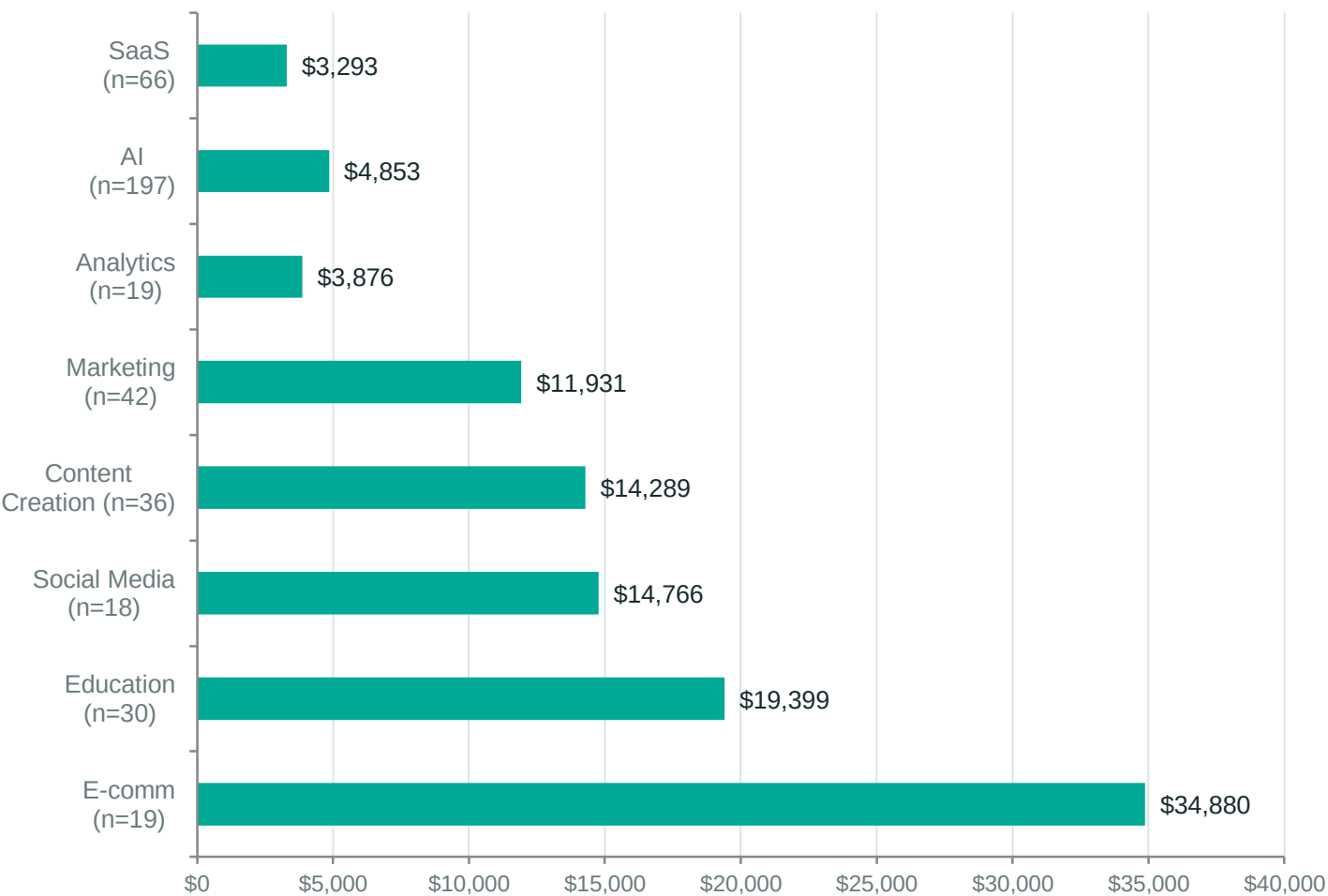
Held by just the top 10 companies

Companies by all-time revenue tier



Sector Performance: Scale vs. Consistency

Median all-time revenue per company, by sector (sectors with n ≥ 18 companies)



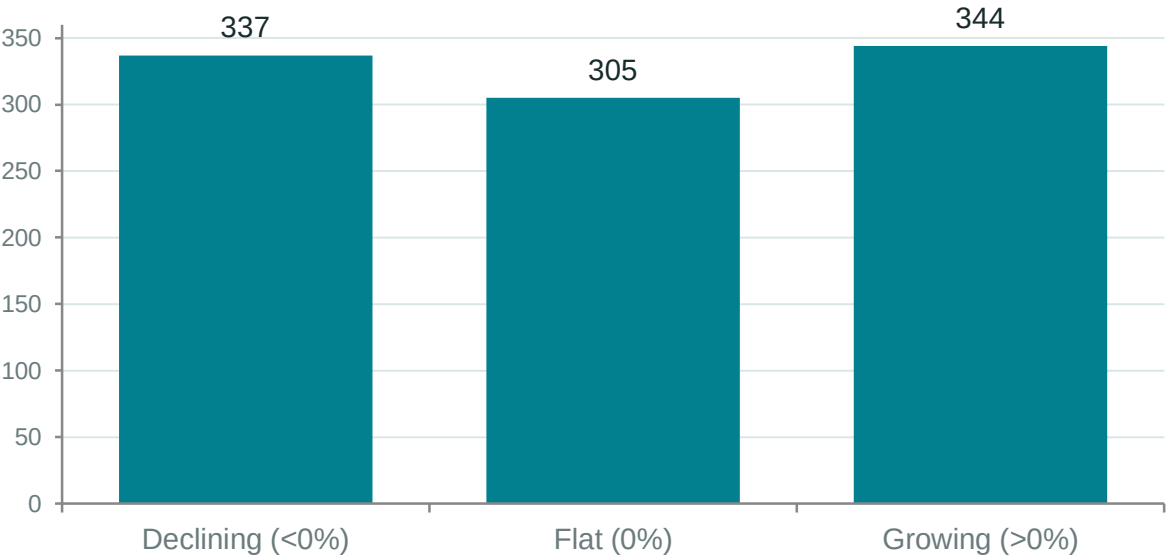
Read the chart carefully

- **E-comm's #1 rank is one company.** 94% of E-comm's total revenue is Brand On Demand alone.
- **Marketing is similar.** 78% of Marketing's total is Stack Influence.
- **AI is the broadest base.** 197 companies — the largest cohort by far — with the 2nd-highest total revenue (\$31.9M) and highest total MRR (\$1.8M), without one dominant outlier.
- **SaaS and AI have low medians.** Most individual companies are still small; sector totals lean on a handful of larger players.

Growth Is Flat For Half The Dataset

30-day revenue growth split, and what MRR reveals about revenue quality

30-day revenue growth (986 companies reporting)



Median growth = 0%. Mean growth = +42% — pulled up by a few extreme spikes (max +7,900%).

MRR vs. reported revenue diverge

For a pure subscription business, $MRR \times 12$ should roughly equal 12-month revenue. In this dataset the typical company's actual figure differs from that estimate by 73%.

This means most companies here aren't pure-subscription — one-time sales, usage-based pricing, or seasonal spikes make up a meaningful share of revenue alongside MRR.

0.91

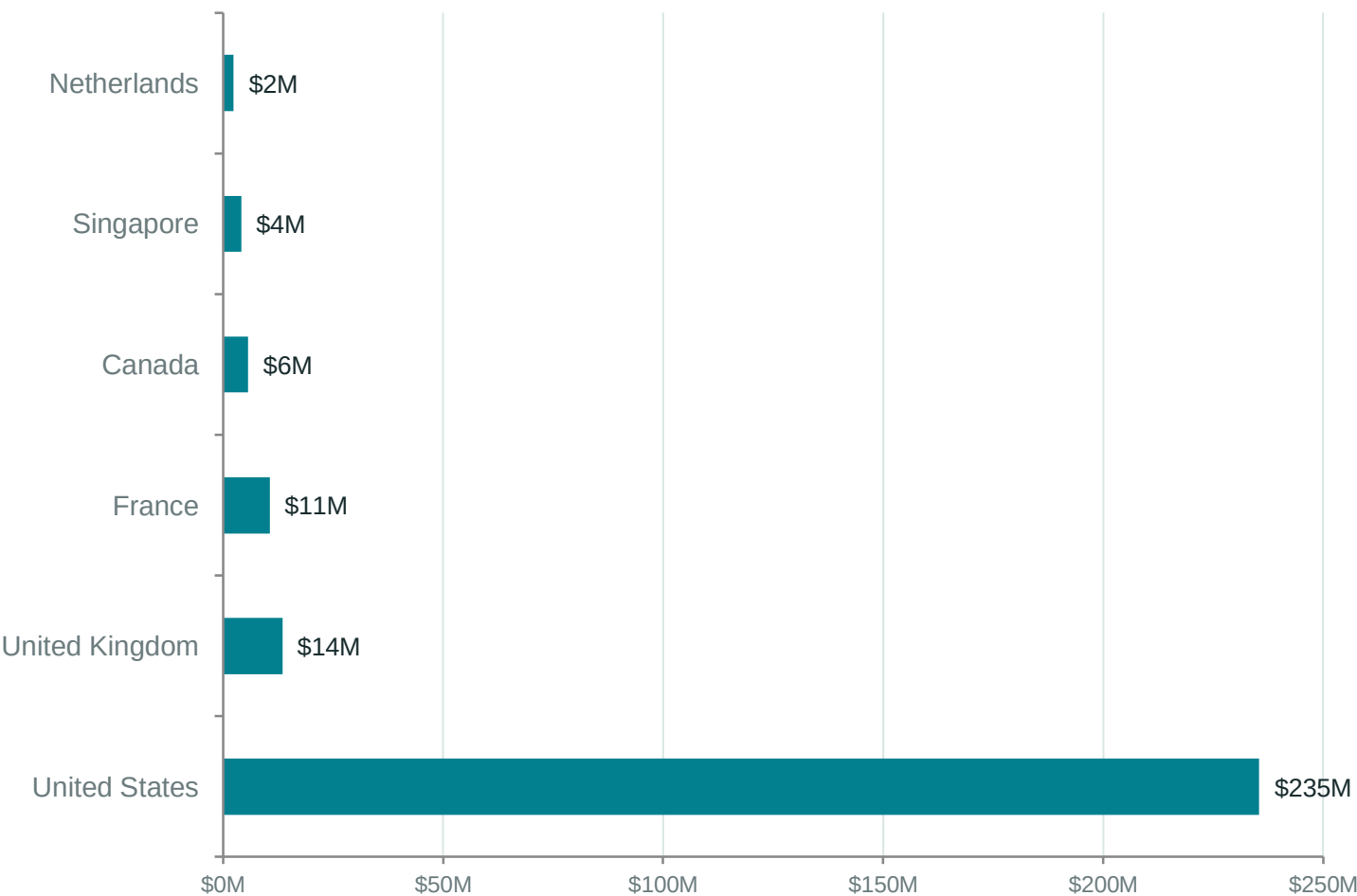
Correlation between active subscriptions and MRR — subscriber count is a strong, reliable predictor of recurring revenue.

0.27

Correlation between domain authority (SEO rating) and revenue — a much weaker relationship.

The US Dominates Tracked Revenue

Top countries by total all-time revenue, across 65 countries represented



~70%

of all revenue with a known country traces back to US-based companies

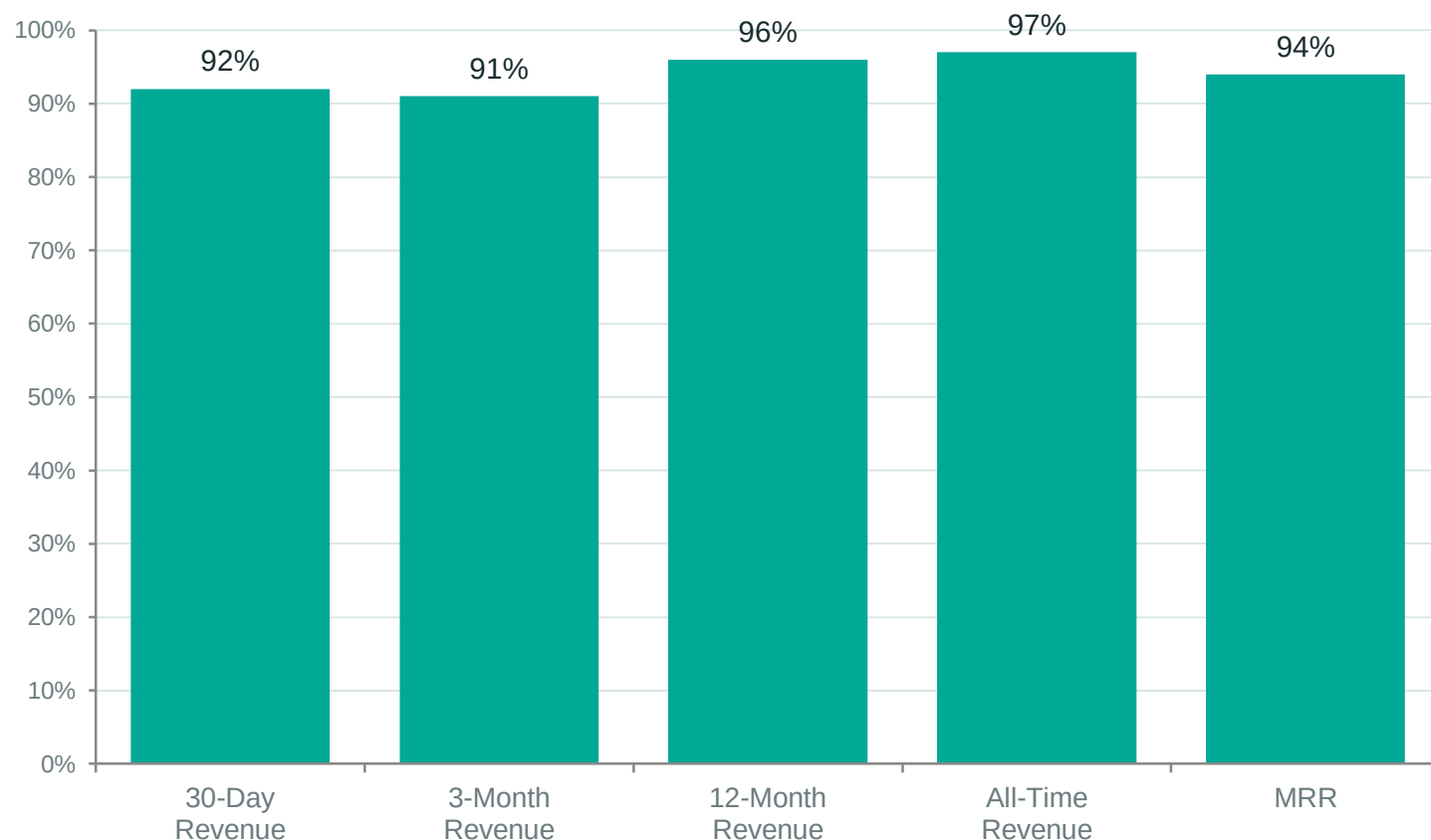
258 US companies (26% of the dataset) generate the large majority of tracked revenue — the next 5 countries combined still total less than 1/6th of the US figure.

12% of total revenue sits with companies whose country field is blank (mostly “Stealth” / “Hidden” listings) and isn't attributable to any country above.

Revenue Isn't Normally Distributed — Even After Log Transform

Anderson-Darling normality test on raw revenue/MRR columns, compared before and after log transform

Reduction in Anderson-Darling statistic after log-transforming each column



What the test found

- Every raw revenue, MRR, and growth column fails the Anderson-Darling normality test by a huge margin (statistic 267–328 vs. a 0.751 critical value).
- Log-transforming revenue/MRR cuts the AD statistic by 91–97% — the data becomes roughly bell-shaped in the middle.
- But log-revenue still formally fails, because ~11% of companies report exactly \$0 all-time revenue — a spike no log-normal curve can produce.
- Practical takeaway: use $\log(1+\text{revenue})$ for modeling, not raw revenue — and handle the zero-revenue companies as a separate group rather than assuming one smooth distribution.

Conclusions

- 1 This is a power-law market, not a normal one.** Median company revenue is \$3,620; mean is \$334,000. 61% of all revenue sits with 10 companies out of 1,000.
- 2 “Best sector” depends on the question.** By total revenue, E-comm and Marketing look strongest — but that's one whale company each. AI is the sector with genuine breadth: 197 companies, highest total MRR, no single dominant outlier.
- 3 Growth is flat for half the dataset.** Median 30-day growth is 0%. Extreme swings (-100% to +7,900%) exist but are the exception, not the norm.
- 4 Revenue quality varies — not everyone is pure-subscription.** $\text{MRR} \times 12$ diverges from 12-month revenue by 73% typically, pointing to mixed one-time and recurring revenue models.
- 5 Model log-revenue, not raw revenue.** Log-transforming closes 91–97% of the normality gap, but ~11% of companies at exactly \$0 revenue still need separate treatment.